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ARTICLE

Two Visions For The World Collided At The UN - And Israel Is At The Center





BY PNW STAFF SEPTEMBER 24, 2026

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For several days, world leaders have walked to the same podium in New York and spoken about war, security, artificial intelligence, climate, international law and the future. But listen carefully and something much bigger emerges.

They are describing two very different visions of how the world should be governed.

One places national sovereignty at the center. Nations cooperate when it serves their interests but ultimately retain control over their laws, borders, technology, military and foreign policy. The other places growing emphasis on multilateralism: stronger international institutions, global standards, international law and coordinated action when individual governments refuse to follow an emerging international consensus.

And remarkably, Israel is becoming one of the clearest fault lines separating those two visions.

America: We Will Decide For Ourselves

President Donald Trump's message to the United Nations was unmistakable. America will cooperate, negotiate and maintain alliances, but it will not surrender its sovereignty to international institutions.

Trump denounced attempts by unelected "globalist bureaucrats" to dictate policy to sovereign nations. His administration has opposed the International Criminal Court and resisted efforts to place American technology under international oversight.

The underlying principle is straightforward: international cooperation, yes; international control, no.

UN Secretary-General António Guterres presented a markedly different vision. He argued that international institutions need to become stronger and that today's challenges require shared rules, international cooperation and a revitalized multilateral system.

Artificial intelligence illustrates the divide. Guterres has called for a multilateral AI risk-management framework with independent oversight. Trump wants America leading the AI revolution without handing control of American technology to international regulators.

These are more than disagreements over bureaucracy. They are competing ideas about who ultimately gets to make the rules.

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Then There Is Israel

Nowhere was the divide more visible than Israel.

Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdoğan used his UN appearance to demand greater international pressure on Israel while again calling for dramatic reform of the international system. Jordan's King Abdullah questioned why sanctions, embargoes and diplomatic isolation have been applied elsewhere while international resolutions concerning Israel repeatedly remain unenforced. Qatar's emir likewise demanded greater pressure on Israel and urged additional countries to recognize a Palestinian state.

France, Britain and Canada have moved toward greater coordination over Palestinian statehood and measures intended to preserve a two-state solution. Guterres told a high-level meeting that support for Palestinian statehood must move beyond declarations and become concrete "policies, decisions and actions."

That language deserves attention because the debate is increasingly moving from condemnation toward consequences: sanctions, trade restrictions, arms limitations, international court actions and diplomatic pressure.

The mechanisms already exist. What has often been missing is sufficient international agreement to use them.



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America Stands Apart

One recent UN vote provided an extraordinary snapshot of the divide. When the General Assembly considered allowing Palestinian Authority President Mahmoud Abbas to address the gathering virtually after Washington denied him a visa, the vote was 152-3.

Only Israel, the United States and Paraguay voted no.

Whatever one's opinion of that particular resolution, the larger picture is difficult to miss. Israel and America stood together while most of the international community stood somewhere else.

That raises a much bigger question: What happens if America eventually moves?

Global Government May Not Look Like We Expected

When people hear "global government," they often imagine nations surrendering their flags and authority to a single institution. But increasing global governance doesn't require nations to disappear.

It can develop through international courts, health agreements, AI standards, climate commitments, financial regulations, digital identity frameworks, sanctions, treaties and multinational security arrangements. Presidents and parliaments remain, but around them develops an increasingly dense network of international rules and obligations.

That is why the competing visions expressed in New York matter. One sees international institutions as increasingly necessary for managing problems that cross national borders. The other insists those institutions must never become masters over sovereign nations.

America currently stands firmly in the second camp.

But Presidents Change

If the United States continues down its current path, Washington could increasingly reject international institutions it considers hostile to American interests, refuse international authority over its citizens and allies, resist international regulation and continue using its Security Council veto to protect Israel.

Under that scenario, America could become a powerful outlier in a world pursuing deeper multilateral coordination.

But administrations change, and there is another possible path.

The UN cannot simply announce that its resolutions supersede the U.S. Constitution. General Assembly resolutions generally do not override American law. Yet future administrations could voluntarily integrate America more deeply into international systems through treaties, regulatory harmonization, international institutions, judicial mechanisms and shared technological, financial, environmental and health standards.

America would remain sovereign on paper, but the practical question would be how much freedom remains after accepting layer upon layer of international obligations.

For Israel, the question becomes even more consequential: Could America eventually move toward the international consensus concerning Jerusalem?

The Prophetic Question America Cannot Avoid

Students of Bible prophecy immediately recognize the significance of Israel becoming the focus of international attention.

Zechariah describes Jerusalem becoming a burdensome stone and nations gathering against it. Joel describes nations being gathered for judgment and specifically connects that judgment with their treatment of God's people and division of the land.

Those passages don't tell us America's future role.

But that itself presents a fascinating question.

Right now, America is the primary diplomatic and military power standing beside Israel. Yet there is no unmistakable United States standing beside Jerusalem in the prophetic passages describing the nations converging against Israel.

That doesn't prove America disappears or abandons Israel. America's power could decline, its policies could change, or the United States may simply be outside the prophetic camera frame. Scripture doesn't tell us.

But look at the direction of travel.

International pressure on Israel is growing. Governments are coordinating their positions. International institutions provide mechanisms through which consensus can become action. Meanwhile, America currently stands apart, insisting that sovereign nations — not international institutions — must ultimately determine their own course.

Two visions of the future are taking shape.

Israel is already standing on the fault line.

And the unanswered question may be where America will stand when that becomes impossible to straddle.

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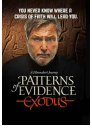
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